Michael Ketigian

Narrative Strategy | Creative Technology | Operations

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I turn complex ideas into strategy, positioning, and language that help people learn, care, and act. Throughout my career I've also built the systems teams use to communicate and get work done, such as Agile project management, operating standards, and SOPs. I bring an engineering degree, over a decade of client work, and a parallel practice in performance poetry and media.

Experience

michaelXmachina

2026 · Remote

Independent Practice

A sabbatical year working with agentic AI systems to better understand the benefits and risks of AI firsthand. Drawing on my background as a Scrum-certified project manager, I built several software prototypes, including vendor-agnostic agent orchestration and continuity tools; a local, offline voice interface; personal tools for life and goal management; and tools that support my creative process. My current focus is refining agentic video pipelines to support content creation covering AI safety.

Symantic Studio

2020–2025 · Remote

Founder & Strategist

Brand and narrative strategy, messaging, and occasional operations, primarily for technology companies and VCs. Portfolio page.

Select Projects

> **Everyday Dose** · 2021–2023, 2025
>
> Established brand and messaging foundations in year 1, then contributed messaging, strategy, and operations through year 3. Returned in year 5 as Messaging Lead and Brand Strategist to help the fast-growing company prepare for its expansion into retail.
>
> **#144 on the 2026 Inc. 5000 · $150M+ annual revenue in 2025 · 5,000+ retail stores as of August 2026**
>
> **Agency Engagements** · 2020–2025
>
> - Branding, strategy, positioning, and messaging in collaboration with Future Works and Dakotomy.
> - Mostly venture-backed tech companies, including Astroscale, Ursa Major, OfferFit, Fabric, Nextpower, Merlyn Mind, Veryfi, GNC, Partsimony, Phantom Space, and Rumi Labs. Also four venture firms: Matter, Meritech, Redpoint, and Ballistic.
> - After our engagements, Ursa Major raised $323M, Braze agreed to acquire OfferFit for $325M, and the four venture firms announced or filed $2.4B in new funds.

Experience, Continued

Good Market

2018–2019 · Remote

Project Manager, Operations

Nonprofit global marketplace for people-and-planet-first businesses, supported by Microsoft and SAP through the Social Enterprise World Forum.

Sourced and managed a distributed software development team to launch the digital marketplace.

Independent Consultant

2016–2018 · Colombo & Remote

Branding & Writing

Freelance branding, copywriting, and journalism; launched and managed a coworking space with a local partner.

Hackerati

2013–2015 · New York

Director of Operations

Software consultancy serving Huffington Post, Viacom, small businesses, and startups.

- Led business development, marketing, recruiting, and event coordination, reporting directly to the cofounders.
- Managed Agile engineering and design teams as a Scrum-certified project manager.
- Led special projects, including coordinating and presenting at two UN events.

Mini-Circuits

2012 · New York

RF & Microwave Engineer

Developed and tested microwave and RF components for a global industry leader of 50+ years.

Selected Stages

- **UN General Assembly** · 2020: wrote and performed a live Rap Up to close the Digital Cooperation event.
- **Climate Hub at WEF, Davos** · 2025: rap translator in the Regenerative Roadshow keynote with Chad Frischmann of Project Drawdown.
- **IDEA Week, University of Notre Dame** · 2019: moderated a blockchain panel and opened for Bill Nye with a Rap Up.
- **TEDxColombo** · 2016
- **Channel NewsAsia** · 2018: my data-privacy piece became the introduction to Episode 3 of *Inside The Cryptokingdom*.

Watch: Bitcoin vs Libra (2019)

Education

The Cooper Union for the Advancement of Science and Art

2012 · New York

Bachelor of Science in Engineering

Interdisciplinary engineering with a focus on electrical engineering and integrated systems.

Thesis project: real-time indoor location tracking via RFID.

Full-Tuition Scholarship · Dean's List